

win the big one. Felix continued to believe this fallacy even as his losses continued to mount.

When it became apparent to Felix that he was going to lose his house, his car, and maybe his medical practice through bankruptcy, the thought of his lie being uncovered was more than he could bear. To admit the truth to his family and friends was not a possibility. He had been avoiding the problem until it became so insurmountable that he saw only one possibility. He solved his problem by taking his own life.

Felix felt his situation was hopeless because his debt was so high, but there are many other circumstances where people think their situation is just as impossible to resolve. They believe their financial situation is hopeless because they:

- Are not good with numbers
- Were never taught about money
- Are paid on commission, with no regular salary
- Are unskilled
- Have serious medical problems
- Are divorced and have to pay alimony and/or child support
- Are divorced and don't receive alimony and/or child support
- Are too old/too young

All of these situations present challenges, but no financial situation is ever hopeless. Even a bankruptcy allows for a relatively fresh start. Sitting back and doing nothing because you don't believe a solution exists is guaranteeing that your situation will never improve. Being willing to admit to yourself that there is a problem is the first step. Admitting the problem to others is the next step. Felix never got to the second step.

At first, Felix's death seemed incomprehensible. How

